Summary

- Use the `HttpClient` class for calling HTTP APIs. You can use it to make HTTP calls to APIs, providing all the headers and body to send in a request, and reading the response headers and data you get back.
- `HttpClient` uses a pipeline of handlers, consisting of multiple `HttpMessageHandlers` connected in a similar way to the middleware pipeline used in ASP.NET Core. The final handler is the `HttpClientHandler`, which is responsible for making the network connection and sending the request.
- `HttpClient` implements `IDisposable`, but typically you shouldn't dispose of it. When the `HttpClientHandler` that makes the TCP/IP connection is disposed of, it keeps a connection open for the `TIME_WAIT` period. Disposing of many `HttpClient`s in a short period of time can lead to socket exhaustion, preventing a machine from handling any more requests.
- Before .NET Core 2.1, the advice was to use a single `HttpClient` for the lifetime of your application. Unfortunately, a singleton `HttpClient` will not respect DNS changes, which are commonly used for traffic management in cloud environments.